

Rebels' admission to WAC delayed

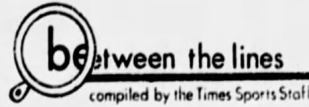
Point to ponder: The Air Force Academy Cadet Honor Code says, "We will not lie, steal or cheat, nor tolerate among us anyone who does." So why did the Air Force Academy join a league with New Mexico and Nevada-Las Vegas? ...

UNLV apparently is in the delayed entry program for the Western Athletic Conference. The Rebels' admission has been put off at least another year, to the 1981-82 campaign. That's good news for the rest of the WAC schools, particularly UTEP, which could be the favorite for the league title in '80-81 with the Rebs still ineligible. UNLV has brought in two super freshmen this season, plus some redshirts and "walk-ons" to blend with last season's freshman finds, Michael Burns and Richard Box.

And, reportedly, Brigham Young next season will be without Devin Durrant, who's due to go on a two-year church mission.

Ken Hayes, who resigned at New Mexico State last spring to take the head coaching post at Oral Roberts, may have hit a unique basketball quinnella Jan. 20. On that night, NMSU, Tulsa — the two schools where he coached previously — and ORU all played in Tulsa.

NMSU, of course, was at Tulsa in a



Missouri Valley Conference game and ORU hosted Xavier (Ohio) in ORU's first conference game ever. So, all of Hayes' 200-plus coaching victories were represented in the Oil Capital.

Larry Bird gets most of the ink in the Boston Celtics' restoration to greatness but, writes Steve Hershey in *The Sporting News*, "Nate Archibald is the player the Celtics would have the most trouble replacing ... Nowhere in the organization is there a player who can do all the things that Archibald accomplishes."

Celtic Coach Bill Fitch says of the former UTEP star (1968-70): "Tiny's just been fantastic. He runs the offense ..."

Jefferson's baseball team is feeling kind of unwanted when it comes to having a home field.

You see, the Foxes don't have a field on their campus and, for years, they have used Hugo Meyer Field at Washington Park, just down the street from Jeff. But a new sprinkler

system had to be installed and work began late last year and is still not completed. So, Jefferson will have to play most of their home games at Ascarate Park.

Says Jeff Coach Al Silva, "The field there is not too bad but, hopefully, we'll have Hugo ready by the time district starts."

Not having Hugo available may have forced problems in scheduling the Fox Country and Burges Invitational baseball tournaments. Both are usually run at both Dudley Field and Hugo Meyer. Burges this year will play its tournament at the Mustang field and the field at MacArthur School. Jefferson will run the entire Fox Country Invitational at Dudley Field.

Former New Mexico State coach Lou Henson is finding life difficult in the Big Ten. His Illinois team was No. 1 for a spell last season but fell quickly from the limelight. This season, according to a recent *Chicago Tribune* article, Henson is getting flak from fans because of the way he substitutes.

New Mexico State fans probably weren't too impressed with Ralph Drollinger when the 7-foot-2 former UCLA center scored 6 points in Ath-

letes in Action's 80-70 exhibition victory over the Aggies Jan. 31.

But a report in *The Sporting News* says Drollinger might be headed to the new Dallas franchise when he ends a four-year commitment to AIA at the end of its season March 27.

You see, Arkansas Coach Eddie Sutton is supposedly a top candidate to become the coach at Dallas and Sutton considers Drollinger the top amateur center in the country, according to TSN.

A hint for high school and college baseball players interested in a major league career: Catch the ball with two hands.

At Thursday's double-header between UTEP and Ranger Junior College, Cleveland Indians scout Jack Cassini was talking to former Miner coach Andy Cohen when left fielder Greg McCurdy made the final out of the inning with a one-handed grab of a fly ball.

"I don't like to see ball players slap at the ball," Cassini told Cohen. "A kid will catch the ball and the next thing you know, he's bouncing it on the ground."

Cassini and Cohen both managed in the Southern League during the 1955 season. Cassini was the player manager. (Please see *Between*, Page 2D)